

# PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Azure and M365 | Zero Trust | IAM | CISSP

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience designing, implementing, and managing security controls across Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments. I specialise in Zero Trust security architecture, Identity and Access Management (IAM), and cloud security engineering, with deep hands-on expertise in Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO). I have a strong track record of monitoring security systems, analysing events escalated from managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) partnerships, and leading incident response aligned to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 framework. I bring experience developing and maintaining security policies and standards aligned to NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials Plus, and I am skilled in providing technical security guidance to IT teams and evaluating new security technologies to strengthen organisational resilience. My background in higher education has given me extensive experience operating within a public sector governance and compliance environment, including regulatory reporting and security assurance functions.

## CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Azure and M365 Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) | Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) | Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender | Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) | Conditional Access | Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management and Mobile Application Management)
- **Zero Trust and Identity:** Zero Trust architecture and strategy | Identity and Access Management (IAM) | Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) | Single Sign-On (SSO) | BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) | Least-privilege access enforcement
- **SIEM and Security Monitoring:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) | CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alert analysis | Incident detection and response from managed SOC escalations
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework | Root-cause analysis | Containment, eradication, and recovery | Post-incident reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) | Tenable.io | AppCheck | Nessus | Remediation tracking and reporting
- **Security Governance and Policy:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) | CIS Controls | ISO 27001 | Cyber Essentials Plus | Security policy development and maintenance | Technical security guidance
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell | Kusto Query Language (KQL) | Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer | Microsoft 365 (M365) | Present
- Design, implement, and manage security controls across Microsoft 365 (M365) environments, ensuring appropriate protection of cloud infrastructure, data, and user identities across the institution.
- Develop and implement Zero Trust security architecture principles, including Conditional Access policies, Just-in-Time (JIT) access, device compliance enforcement via Microsoft Intune, and network micro-segmentation strategies.
  - Manage and maintain Identity and Access Management (IAM) systems and processes, including Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) lifecycle management, role-based access control, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and privileged account governance via BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM).

- Monitor security systems and analyse security events escalated from the managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) partnership, conducting investigations, root-cause analysis, and coordinating incident response aligned to NIST 800-61.
- Develop and maintain security policies and standards in alignment with NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Provide technical security guidance to IT teams on secure architecture, cloud configuration, identity governance, and endpoint hardening.
- Evaluate and recommend new security technologies, conducting proof-of-concept assessments and producing business cases for security investment aligned to risk appetite.
- Lead Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io vulnerability scanning programmes, managing remediation tracking and reporting to senior stakeholders.
- Manage Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance, encryption, and application control policies across a diverse endpoint estate.

**University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity**  
 Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), Conditional Access Policies, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for a user base of over 8,000 staff and students, ensuring secure identity governance and access management across the institution. *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Supported the implementation and management of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the full UAL estate, providing comprehensive visibility for threat detection and identity-based incident response.
- Operated Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), monitoring security events and investigating alerts generated from cloud, endpoint, and identity data sources.
- Maintained BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, managing privileged credential vaulting, session recording, and access reviews in line with least-privilege and Zero Trust principles.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing remediation reports and working with system owners to resolve identified exposures.
- Contributed to security policy development and maintained documentation aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus certification requirements.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate identity lifecycle management tasks, access reporting, and security event enrichment.

**HUX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure**  
 Implemented and maintained security controls and identity management processes within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, ensuring alignment with applicable security policies and regulatory obligations. *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Managed endpoint security, network access controls, and infrastructure security monitoring, supporting operational continuity and risk reduction across a growing technology company.
- Contributed to security policy development, internal audit activities, and infrastructure quality assurance processes.

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## KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

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- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the 8,000-user UAL estate, achieving full endpoint and identity telemetry coverage and establishing a foundation for Zero Trust security monitoring.
- Designed and implemented a comprehensive Zero Trust security architecture for UAL, integrating Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Microsoft Intune compliance policies, and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) into a unified identity-centric control framework.
- Built and maintained Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection content using Kusto Query Language (KQL), achieving measurable improvements in detection fidelity and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD).
- Implemented Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that automated alert triage and enrichment, freeing analyst capacity and ensuring consistent, repeatable incident response.
- Drove Cyber Essentials Plus certification renewal, coordinating cross-team remediation of identified gaps in network segmentation, patch management, and access control.

- Introduced Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to UAL's security assurance programme, enabling continuous validation of security controls and evidence-based risk reporting to senior leadership.
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## EDUCATION

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- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
  - B.Sc. Chemical Engineering
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## CERTIFICATIONS

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- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
  - CompTIA Security+
  - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
  - CompTIA A+
  - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Bedford/Remote)